



To see why the Law of the Excluded Middle (LEM) leads to fate, consider a proposition about a possible future free action of yours.

The law of the excluded middle

For any proposition  $P$ , either  $P$  is true or  $\text{Not-}P$  is true.

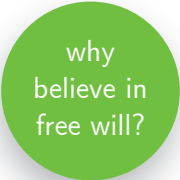
The LEM tells us that either (i) this is true, or (ii) its negation is true.



two  
arguments  
against free  
will



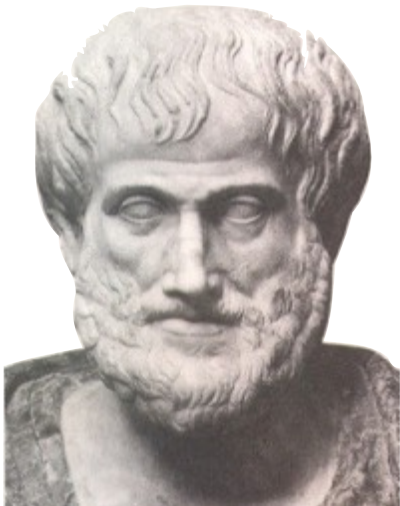
is fate  
real?



why  
believe in  
free will?



three  
ways out



You will get married  
on July 1, 2030.

You will not get married  
on July 1, 2030.

action of yours.

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So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

things as fate, then there is no free will.

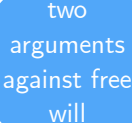
and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?





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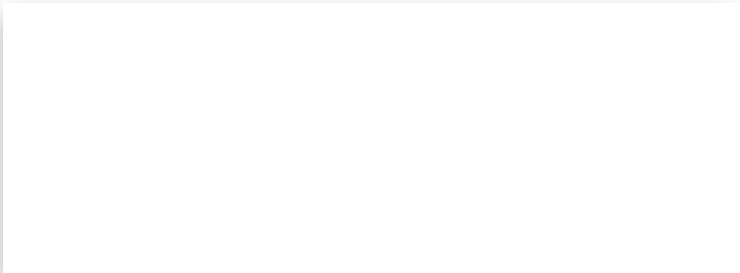
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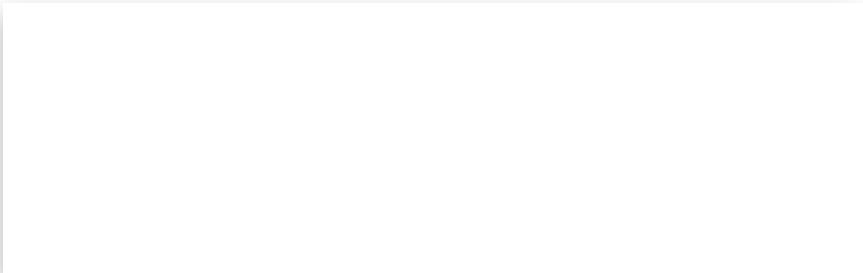


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freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

responding to Edwards' argument. But

for fatalsn.

first let's think about how Edwards'

argument might be related to an argument

We'll shortly consider some ways of

Suppose that someone did not believe in

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

there were truths about all our future

actions. Could they give an argument

similar to Edwards' argument?

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

with reference to the being of truth about

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.

replace reference to God's foreknowledge



3 We have not the fact that

1. We have no direct facts.

that if it is true that I will perform

God knows that in the future I will

some action, then I will prefer that

2\*In the past, there were truths about

5\* We have noticed that the fact

4. If we have no choice about  $p$ , and no

(3, 4, 5)

acaioid.

will perform various actions.

perform a certain action (1,2)

0 We have achieved what we

then we have the choice about q.

choice about the fact that if  $p$ , then  $q$ ,



all of our activities.

The fatalist argument



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